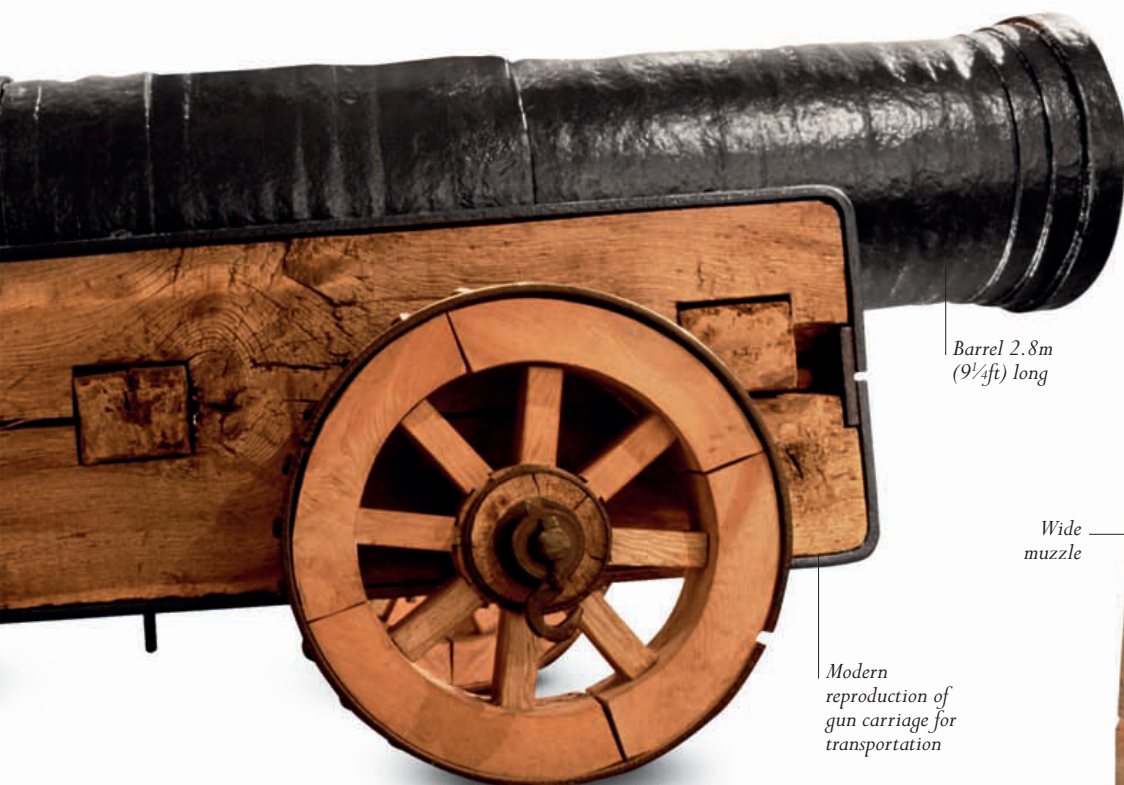




◀ MONS MEG

Date 1449

Origin Flanders

Weight 5.08 tonnes (5.5 tons)

Length 4.04m (13 1/4 ft)

Calibre 49.6cm

Range 2.61km (1 1/2 miles)

This massive bombard was presented to James II of Scotland in 1457. It fired stone balls that weighed almost 200kg (440lb), but was too cumbersome for regular service, as it could only be moved 5km (3 miles) a day.



▼ FLEMISH BOMBARD

Date Early 15th century

Origin Flanders

Material Forged hoop-and-stave iron

Shot Stone balls

Large medieval siege guns, known as bombards, were muzzle-loaders. The stone balls they hurled were loaded through the muzzle after the powder charge. Flanders, where this bombard was made, had a strong tradition of gun-casting, particularly under Charles the Bold (1433–77).

▲ MORTAR

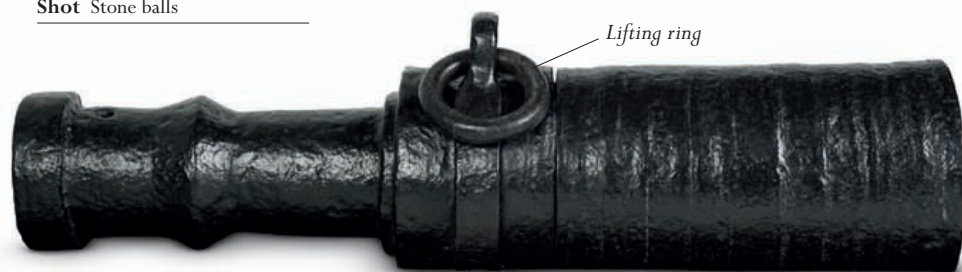
Date 15th–16th century

Origin England

Length 1.25m (4ft)

Calibre 36cm

This mortar was found in the moat of Bodiam Castle, England (see pp.84–85). It was lit by a touch fuse at the end of the barrel, and was used to fire projectiles such as stones or perhaps incendiaries at a steep upward angle.



▼ ENGLISH SWIVEL GUN

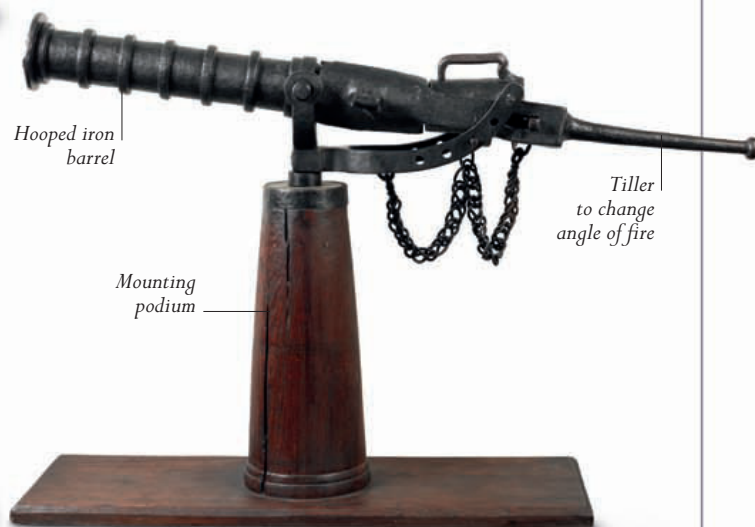
Date Late 15th century

Origin England

Length 1.36m (4 1/2 ft)

Calibre 2in

Swivel-loading guns were frequently employed for naval use. This model was mounted on the gunwales of a ship, where the superior arc of fire could be used to rake enemy vessels. Like most swivel guns, it is a breech-loader.



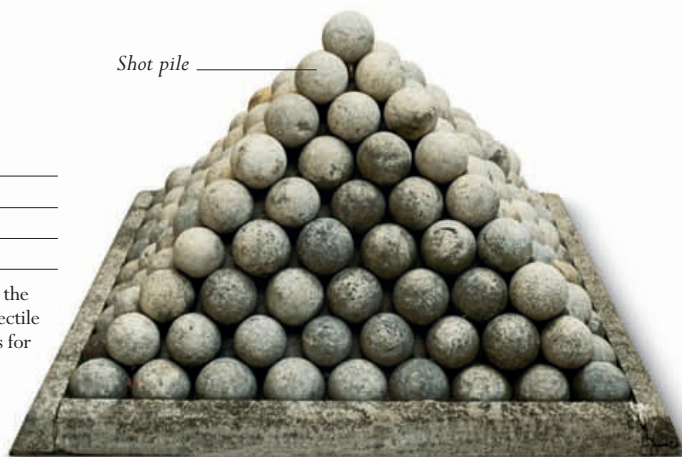
► CANNONBALLS

Date 14th–16th century

Origin Italy

Material Stone

In the early days of artillery, the most common form of projectile was stone balls. Cannonballs for the largest bombards could weigh up to 200kg (440lb) and inflict devastating damage on city walls.



◀ SWEDISH SWIVEL GUNS

Date c.1500

Origin Sweden

Material Iron

Shot Round or grapeshot

Swivel guns first appeared in the late 14th century, providing a greater arc of fire. They were mainly breech-loading, with the pre-loaded charge placed in a chamber at the back of the bore for firing. These Swedish models would have been mounted on a boat or a building.